POLICY

Acceptable Use & Password Policy

For a 30-person Software Company

VERSION	1.0	**DATE**	19 October 2026
CLASSIFICATION	INTERNAL	**AUDIENCE**	All Employees
PREPARED BY	Hiderox Technologies		

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1. Introduction and Purpose

This policy outlines the guidelines for the acceptable use of company IT resources and establishes mandatory standards for password management and authentication across the organization. Adherence to this policy is required for all employees, contractors, and third-party users accessing company systems.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all hardware, software, networks, cloud services, and data owned, leased, or managed by the company, regardless of physical location. This includes company-issued devices and personal devices used for company business (BYOD).

3. Acceptable Use Policy (AUP)

3.1 General Usage Guidelines

All company resources are provided for legitimate business purposes. Employees must use these resources responsibly and ethically.

- **Prohibited Activities:** Unauthorized access to systems, downloading illegal content, engaging in harassment, or using company resources for personal gain that conflicts with company interests are strictly forbidden.
- **Data Handling:** Company data must be handled according to its classification (Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted). Sensitive data must never be shared outside approved channels.
- **Monitoring:** Employees should be aware that all activity on company systems is subject to monitoring, logging, and review by the IT department to ensure compliance with this policy and legal obligations.

3.2 Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Policy

The company permits the use of personal devices (smartphones, laptops) for limited work purposes, provided they meet security standards.

- **Registration:** All BYOD devices must be registered with the IT department.
- **Security Requirements:** Devices must maintain up-to-date operating systems, have full disk encryption enabled, and require a strong passcode/biometric lock.
- **Data Segregation:** Employees must use approved Mobile Device Management (MDM) profiles to ensure company data is segregated from personal data. The company reserves the right to remotely wipe company data from a device if the device is lost, stolen, or employment terminates.

4. Password and Authentication Policy

Strong authentication is mandatory to protect company assets against unauthorized access.

4.1 Password Requirements

All user accounts must adhere to the following minimum standards:

- **Complexity:** Passwords must be a minimum of 14 characters long.
- **Composition:** Passwords must include a mix of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and symbols.
- **Uniqueness:** Passwords must never be reused across different services.
- **Rotation:** While modern security practices favor long, unique passphrases over frequent rotation, passwords must be changed immediately if a compromise is suspected or if the service mandates a change.

4.2 Mandatory Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

MFA is mandatory for accessing all critical company systems, including:

- Email (Microsoft 365/Google Workspace)
- VPN access
- Cloud storage platforms
- Internal administrative portals
- Any service storing sensitive customer or proprietary data.
- **Implementation:** Employees must use approved authenticator apps (e.g., Microsoft Authenticator, Google Authenticator) or hardware security keys (e.g., YubiKey) for MFA. SMS-based MFA is discouraged unless no other option is available.

4.3 Password Management

The use of a centralized, approved password manager is mandatory for all employees.

- **Tooling:** The company mandates the use of [Insert Approved Password Manager Name Here, e.g., 1Password, Bitwarden].
- **Storage:** Passwords must *never* be written down, stored in plain text files, or shared via unencrypted channels (e.g., email, chat).
- **Access:** Access to the password manager vault must be protected by MFA.

5. Compliance and Enforcement

Failure to comply with this Acceptable Use and Password Policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment and legal action, depending on the severity of the violation.

6. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed annually by the IT Security team to ensure it aligns with current threat landscapes and regulatory requirements.